

DubzChain Phase 6.5 — Release Discipline

This document defines the minimum release discipline for operating DubzChain as a public testnet. Its purpose is to prevent silent network breakage, inconsistent operator behavior, and accidental constant changes.

Area	Required behavior
Backups	Back up chain files, peer table, and wallet files before any upgrade
Constants	Do not silently change frozen network constants
Validation	Verify health, status, replay, peers, and sync after every release
Communication	Document release notes and any compatibility impact
Rollback	Keep a recovery path if an update fails

1. Release rules

- Every public testnet rollout should have written release notes.
- Release notes should clearly state whether the update is compatible with existing chain data and peers.
- Frozen network constants must not change silently.

2. Pre-release checklist

- Back up wallet files.
- Back up chain data and checkpoint/snapshot data if used.
- Back up the peer table file.
- Confirm the intended node startup command before deployment.
- Confirm that advertised peer URLs are still correct.

3. Post-release validation

- Check /health.
- Check /status.
- Check /peers.
- Check /sync.
- Check /debug/replay-verify.
- Check explorer access if /index is part of the deployment.

4. Compatibility discipline

- If network constants change, treat the event as a controlled reset or incompatible rollout.
- Do not ask operators to guess whether old chain data is still valid.
- Do not mix changed constants with previously stored incompatible chain data.

5. Upgrade flow

- Stop the node cleanly.
- Back up important files.
- Deploy the new build.
- Restart with the same intended launch recipe unless the release explicitly changes it.
- Run the post-release validation checks.

6. Rollback / recovery

- If the update fails, use backups rather than improvising partial repairs.
- Restore known-good files when necessary.
- Verify replay and network health after rollback.

7. Operator communication

- Keep one canonical reference for current public seed nodes and bootstrap endpoints.
- Document public-facing peer URLs used by the current release.
- Document any required operator action instead of assuming operators will infer it.

Phase 6.5 completion note

Once this file is saved as the release discipline reference for the public testnet, you can mark 6.5 release discipline complete and close Phase 6.